

4. Certain drives on your computer have suddenly become inaccessible, even though they show up in My Computer.
5. Not being able to print correctly has been stated as an indicator of a viral infection, but don't panic if you get a bad printout. It's probably due to something else. But if it happens in conjunction with other symptoms...
6. Unexpected error messages with weird codes! Of course, error messages are seldom user-friendly, so the key here is how often they pop up, and how weird they are. For example, a big red cross and an OK button that doesn't say "OK".
7. Now this is so typical of possible viral infection that we hardly need to mention it: distorted dialog boxes and menus. Hit "Scan" immediately. And if it turns out not to have been a virus, there's still something wrong with your computer, so have it checked.
8. If, despite all our warnings in the past five years, you still opened a suspicious-looking attachment—driven, of course, by what is called the libido—and immediately after that, everything (or at least some things) went funny, you're in for it. Hit Scan. And hope that the anti-virus *will* scan.
9. It could be that your anti-virus needs a re-install, but it's unlikely: if the anti-virus is disabled and you didn't disable it, you're very likely infected. Before panicking, first try reinstalling the anti-virus. If that doesn't work, panic.
10. Continuing along those dire lines, if you're able to install any program *but* an anti-virus, then yes, you are a victim.
11. When someone tells you he or she got an infected message from you, you almost certainly have something bad on your computer. It might or might not be a virus.
12. A not-so-common symptom, but a deadly giveaway, is the